# Stewardship

***Purpose:*** *Everything belongs to God; as stewards we are responsible to Him for all that He has entrusted to us.*

***Centred on:*** *Jesus Christ gave all for us and calls us to be fully surrendered to Him.*

***Psalm 24:1…***God claims ownership of the material possessions of the earth and specifically of you and me. As Christians this is comforting.

***Exodus 20:8-11…*** not a text to use at the beginning of doing Bible Studies, but by now you will have done other studies. Verse 11 underline "For" God is telling us to keep the Sabbath day Holy. why? Because God is the Creator and the world is His. He can make the claim that he owns the world because He made it. Are there any other reasons why He would claim that everything in the world including the people are His? Lets go to 1 Cor 6:20

***1 Corinthians 6:20 …***We are bought with a price, Jesus paid the price for us. Humans are the double property of God, first because of creation and second by redemption.

Aren't you glad that you are owned by the God that was willing to send you His Son to die for you?

***Isaiah 58:13, 14…***Because everything is God's everything we have Gods, God asks us to manage the things he has given us in specific ways. God teaches us about Time management. Hasn't this been your experience? as you stepped out and trusted Him in honoring the Sabbath? Haven't you found this to be a blessing? (They will have already accepted the Sabbath) My Holy Day (underline) It's God's day. The Sabbath is a delight perhaps you must begin calling it a delight in faith, because you are turning away from your pleasure. Basically He's made a call on our lives because He is our owner.

***Psalm 103: 1-6…*** God takes care of us. Remind God of His goodness, it reminds us as well. Forget not his benefits. Aren't you glad that God doesn't just want you to have long life, but He wants you to enjoy quality of life? We serve a good God don't we?

***Psalm 116:12-14…*** What can I do to show the Lord for everything He has done for me? Remind them or help them to remember victories God has given them. Underline 'I will pay my vows' financial decision they were making for sacrifices of (oil wheat etc) in the presence of all His people (kind of refers to the Sabbath) When we see God's goodness to us, we are led to do something in return. The psalmist wanted to give something that was tangible.

God has given us a way to demonstrate how appreciative we are of him. A tangible way to tell Him we are thankful and to remind us that we acknowledge He is in charge. This is a Transition into tithe.

***Leviticus 27:30 …*** key ideas, tithe is prominent and 'it is holy to the Lord' is important. Tithe is a Biblical word that literally means one tenth, true in both Hebrew and Greek. Tithe refers to any financial increase. Can use verse 32 to show the literal tenth meaning.

***Genesis 14:18-20 …***two examples preceding the Israelites. Even before this time there were people who followed God and kept this principle. (Read this passage to understand) Abram gave a tithe as though it was the most important thing.

***Genesis 28:18-22…***(Side-note, doesn't really have to do with stewardship: Even though Jacob messed up he was convicted, God gives him comfort and assurance.) Jacob returned tithe. Because there is not much explanation it tells us that tithe was something that people back then were familiar with. Underline 'a tenth'

***Malachi 3:8-12 …***rob means that someone stole it while the owner was there. God's intention is to bless us. By bringing tithe back to God we enable Him to bless us. This is the only place that God says 'test me'. Its like a money back guarantee. Tithe is to support others (so there may be food in My house) Ill. Driving on Sabbath and not wanting to pay for gas when you might run out.

***Luke 6:38 …***Reciprocity: when you give it will be given back to you. You can't out-give God. Net or gross? Ill. Honest abe. Do you think God is more honest that Abe? If you overpay God, he will figure out a way to give you back the change. Its always best to run on the side of overpaying, than underpaying. Underline 'give' and 'good measure'

***Numbers 18:21-26…*** Levites took care of the religious services of the Israelites. Tithe was brought to God's place. Brought to the place which funds His salvation on earth, Gospel Ministry, Full time ministry.

## Appeal:

***Mark 10:****17-31…*The Rich Young Ruler; come follow me, was extending a call to be a disciple. Your heart is so selfish that as long as you hold on to your stuff you won't understand my love and mission, there will be something standing between me and you. After 22 you can skip to 28. you will receive 100fold right now. If you let go now, he will reward you. Jesus was expressing the truth, nothing is better or worth more in this present age than peace of God filling our soul and the assurance of eternal life. Do you want to say to God, I'm simply responding to your love today, today I want you to have everything. Do you want to surrender your life to the one that surrendered His life for you? Do you want to be sold-out to Jesus, to be faithful in returning 1/7 of your time and 1/10 of your money. I realize that all I have is yours, and I want to manage it and give it back to you and commit it to you.

God doesn't care if we have lots of money, the problem comes when we think that our possessions are ours, that we are the owners instead of the managers.

***Luke 21:1-4…***This lady was putting her money in to the offering plate to the people that were scheming to kill Jesus. Yet instead of saying you know you should give that money to me, he commended her. We don't need to worry about where our money is going. We need to give and let God take care of it

***John 7:17…***How do we know if we have an idol or are holding something back that we should give to God? "If anyone wills to do His will, He shall know concerning the doctrine, whether it is from God or whether I speak on My own authority."